

Q You have focused a lot on the cloud, whereas if you look at Red Hat's market in India, a major share of your revenue comes from the certifications...

First, we do not have a breakdown of any revenue figures in India. So I cannot give you any details on India-specific numbers. Let's look at it on a worldwide scale. Globally, we get 87 per cent of our revenue from subscriptions, while 13 per cent is from the services. Training and certifications fall in the 13 per cent share, which is a very small part of our business globally. While the cloud, at the end of the day, is the ultimate destination. Realistically, the number of customers deploying a hybrid cloud today can be counted on my fingers. Like HTTP and the Web revolution that came to stay, the cloud will also evolve as a phenomenon. It will take some time to evolve completely but we have to have a vision on how to take customers to a point where they can leverage it.

I spoke to a CIO recently, and he said he wants to be completely suspicious about the cloud and then come out of it, rather than being completely bullish and then getting disappointed. I am talking of one of the top 10 CIOs of the country. So it's not that they are sceptical about the

cloud as a phenomenon, but they want to watch out for what path to take. We want to help our customers in that. India, China and ASEAN markets are unique because a lot of infrastructure is greenfield. There is no legacy and it is a great opportunity. It means starting from scratch. In that sense, we will have to look at this market differently. The 'one size fits all' strategy will not work here. So we will have to cater to the different requirements of different parts of the market with a different game plan.

Q Are you planning to involve SMBs as well in your endeavours?

You talked about certifications and I think that is an interesting reflection of how we are doing with respect to SMBs. India is one of the biggest training industries. A lot of people achieve certifications and enter different segments of the business in the SMB space. The fact that we deliver the highest number certifications globally speaks for the requirements of Linux skills in that space. But because of our business model, where we work through channels, it is really difficult for us to say who is buying Linux and who is consuming it, unless they call us for support. 

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